

the seismic shift in consumer behaviour post Covid-19. “It’s not just about having the money; it’s about the desire to spend,” Soni states. He acknowledges the surge in post-pandemic demand was fuelled not just by pent-up desires but also a newfound need for self-expression. A younger generation is entering the scene, injecting fresh energy into the industry. “People want to enjoy their wealth, experiment, learn, and embrace new technologies. We’re not merely in the business of luxury mobility; we’re crafting a luxury lifestyle. Our goal is to cater to passions, whether it’s food, travel, fashion, or sports,” he says.

Soni stands by a cherished Japanese principle, *omotenashi*, symbolising the art of anticipating and exceeding a guest’s needs, a principle he envisions integrating into the Indian luxury experience. He acknowledges the influx of a younger demographic, estimated at a substantial 30-35 per cent of the market. “It’s no longer about features and usability. Brand storytelling and a profound emotional bond with

the customer have become paramount,” says the Head of Lexus India.

Audi’s Balbir Dhillon agrees. He says it’s about the quality and quantity of a luxury brand today. The shift is palpable, he notes, from the ostentatious mass advertising of yesteryear to a more intimate engagement with the discerning few. “People want to celebrate their luxury,” says the Head of Audi India. Demographics play a pivotal role; 40 per cent of Audi’s clientele belongs to the 25 to 40 years cohort.

NO MORE EXCESSES

Globally, a new trend is emerging, one that Audi India is carefully nurturing—

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